SECRET

1069/2/52/52

FJ 10310/58

BRITISH EMBASSY,
Washington, D.C.
25th February 1952.

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EOD

Dear Rob,

FJ10310/54

I have read with interest Bill Dening's letter to you 1030/65/52 of the 18th February and the enclosed memorandum by George Clutton about Mr. Yoshida's letter to Dulles.

2. I see that in his memorandum Clutton says that we had not been told of the contents of Yoshida's letter although we had been informed of its existence. Strictly speaking this is not correct and in view of the repercussions to Yoshida's letter I had better set down the facts in some detail.

3. On the morning of January 9th Allison telephoned me to say that Dulles had prepared a memorandum giving a chronological account of his various negotiations on the subject of Japan's relations to China. Dulles had thought that it might be useful for Mr. Eden, who had not been associated with these negotiations in their earlier stages, to see a copy of this document. He was well aware that the Ambassador was very occupied with other matters. He wondered, however, if the Ambassador, who would in any case, be accompanying the Foreign Secretary to see Mr. Acheson at the State Department at 4:30 that afternoon would be able to call at Mr. Dulles's office at about four o'clock. Dulles would then be able to hand him a copy of his memorandum and make a few explanatory remarks. This the Ambassador agreed to do.

4. During the brief meeting Dulles not only handed over his memorandum but also produced the Yoshida letter and gave the Ambassador an opportunity to glance through it - but only under the most strict injunctions of secrecy from Dulles, who emphasised that the existence of the letter should not be disclosed to anyone other than the Prime Minister and Foreign Secretary. In view of these injunctions of secrecy it would hardly have been possible to discuss the contents of the letter (at which, in any case, the Ambassador had no more than a hasty glance) at the official discussions with Mr. Acheson. The Ambassador was of course given no copy of the letter and no hint that it was about to be published.

5. I am sending a copy of this letter to Bill Dening.

Yours ever
Tommy

F. S. Tomlinson

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